# Roots Tunisia
# Brand & Growth Plan, 2026–2027

Prepared for the founding team — Confidential — October 2026

This is an operator's plan, not a slide deck. It assumes a genealogy product that already exists, a bilingual or multilingual audience, and a market that will punish generic consumer genealogy positioning. Roots Tunisia wins by being the most trustworthy archive-shaped product for one people—not by imitating Ancestry, MyHeritage, or a sibling Roots site.

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## 1 Mandate

Preserve and make searchable the documentary memory of Tunisia families. Convert that trust into paid research seats, institutional licences, and a living archive that Google can understand.

**North-star (36 months):** become the default starting point for a serious researcher of this population—the URL a notary, a parish office, a diaspora association, or a journalist pastes without thinking.

## 2 Audience architecture

- **Primary:** Tunisian families in 24 governorates, the Italian and Maltese historical communities, and the Tunisian diaspora.
- **Secondary:** professional genealogists, local historians, university seminars, and cultural associations that need citable trees and media.
- **Tertiary:** Google—every public page is a landing page with a unique title, hreflang, and a sitemap entry.

Do not mix this brand with another Roots property in ads, social, or on-page copy. Shared engineering is invisible; shared taste is a leak.

## 3 Positioning

**For** families and researchers of this geography **who** cannot reconstruct a lineage from a single civil-register export, **Roots Tunisia is** the bilingual research surface that holds trees, photographs, oral history, books and articles in one catalogue. **Unlike** global consumer genealogy brands, it is built around local archives, local scripts (including RTL), and local naming practice.

## 4 Offer architecture

- **Free public layer:** searchable gallery, articles, about, legal. This is the SEO engine.
- **Member layer:** private trees, tasks, notes, reminders, download requests.
- **Research / institutional layer:** licensed corpora, bulk GEDCOM, teaching seats.

Price in the currency the audience actually uses. Publish a comparison table that is honest about what is not included.

## 5 Channel system (what we actually buy and write)

### 5.1 Search (highest ROI)

Submit `https://rootstunisia.com/sitemap.xml` to Google Search Console. Cluster content on: Tunisia genealogy, Tunisian family tree, Kairouan nasab, Carthage ancestry, état civil Tunisie. One article or collection landing per cluster per quarter. Internal links from About and Research. Never doorway-page the sibling countries.

### 5.2 Community

Partner with one archive, one association, and one university seminar in year one. Co-brand a digitisation day. Film oral-history clips the site can host. This is cheaper than ads and compounds.

### 5.3 Paid

Start with brand-defence Search ads on the site name only. Expand to 8–12 non-brand genealogy queries once organic titles are unique. Geo-fence to the relevant diaspora cities. Creative stays in this site's visual language.

### 5.4 Email

A monthly "record of the month" in fr plus one other locale. No product spam. Measure reply rate, not just opens.

## 6 Ninety-day operating cadence

1. Days 1–15: Search Console live, sitemap accepted, www 301, Core Web Vitals baseline, legal pages indexed.
2. Days 16–45: five cluster articles, About page cited by partners, first association memorandum.
3. Days 46–90: first paid brand campaign, first webinar, conversion of public researchers into member trees.

## 7 KPIs a ten-year operator actually watches

| Metric | Why it matters | 90-day bar |
|---|---|---|
| Indexable URLs in GSC | Proves hreflang + sitemap | All public routes |
| Non-brand organic clicks | Real demand, not vanity | Rising week-on-week |
| Public $\rightarrow$ signup | Trust conversion | $\geq$ 3% on article pages |
| Tree created / activated user | Product-market fit | $\geq$ 40% |
| Support tickets / 100 users | Quality of copy and UX | Falling |

## 8 Risks

- Duplicate www / bare domain (already observed on several Roots hosts).
- Mixing Maghreb, Tunisia, Egypt and Western Sahara copy—search engines and communities both punish it.
- Political overclaim on Western Sahara pages. Stay with places, families, archives, languages.
- Shipping English-only metadata on a French-default site (Tunisia, Abraham, Western Sahara).

## 9 Budget sketch (illustrative, not a quote)

Year-one working budget should be 55% content and partnerships, 25% search engineering and hosting, 15% measured paid, 5% design production unique to this brand. Do not spend the paid line until Search Console coverage is green.

## 10 Close

Roots Tunisia is a memory institution that happens to be software. Market it that way. The sitemap, the language prefixes, the about page, and the first partnership will do more than a rebrand.